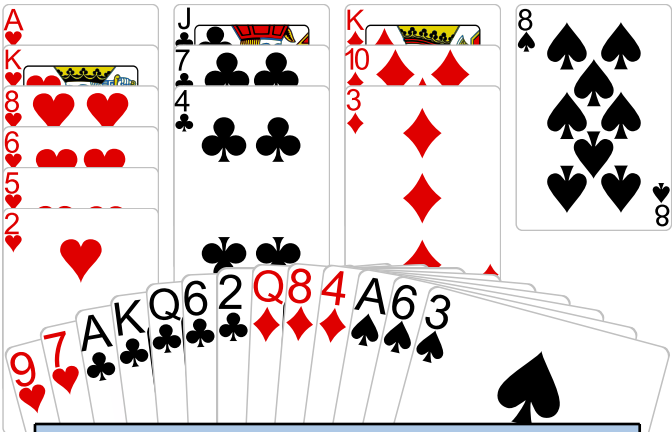
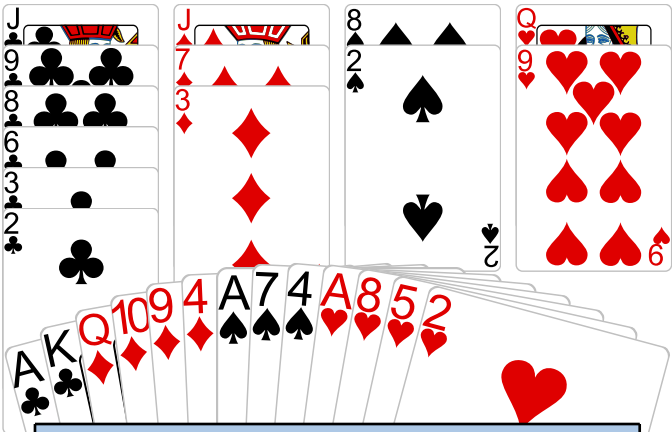


Deal 1 Ctr: 4♥ Goal: at most \_\_\_\_ losers



| Count Fast and Slow Losers  |         |       |        |       |
|-----------------------------|---------|-------|--------|-------|
| ♠                           | ♥       | ♦     | ♣      | Total |
|                             |         |       |        |       |
| Decide How to Reduce Losers |         |       |        |       |
| Ruffs                       | Finesse | Pitch | Length |       |
|                             |         |       |        |       |

Deal 3 Ctr: 3♣ Goal: at most \_\_\_\_ losers



| Count Fast and Slow Losers  |         |       |        |       |
|-----------------------------|---------|-------|--------|-------|
| ♠                           | ♥       | ♦     | ♣      | Total |
|                             |         |       |        |       |
| Decide How to Reduce Losers |         |       |        |       |
| Ruffs                       | Finesse | Pitch | Length |       |
|                             |         |       |        |       |

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3♣

Declarer: East

Board: 5

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 6♠

Declarer: South

**Board 1**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ K 9 7 4  
♥ J 10 4 3  
♦ J 7 6  
♣ 10 8

♠ A 6 3

♥ 9 7

♦ Q 8 4

♣ A K Q 6 2



♠ Q J 10 5 2

♥ Q

♦ A 9 5 2

♣ 9 5 3

♠ 8

♥ A K 8 6 5 2

♦ K 10 3

♣ J 7 4

| West     | North | East | South |
|----------|-------|------|-------|
|          | 1NT   | Pass | 2♦    |
| Pass     | 2♥    | Pass | 4♥    |
| All Pass |       |      |       |

4♥ by North

Loser List: ♠ = 0 : ♥ = ? : ♦ = 2 : ♣ = 0 :: Total = ?

The loser count is very confused, but that ♣ suit is not confused at all. You want to be able to run the ♣s so your plan is to play the ♥ A K, and if both defenders follow go ahead and knock out the last ♥ so they can't ruff your ♣ tricks.

Unfortunately when you play ♥ A K, East plays the ♥ Q, then discards a ♠.

You may think you should change your plan but you should go right ahead with it. West has two master trumps, but dummy still has 4 small ones. So play a ♥ to force out West's ♥ 10. He will no doubt play another ♠ and force dummy to ruff. No problem, knock out West's final ♥ and dummy will still have one tiny trump left. When you get back in you can run the ♣s unimpeded.

Usually it is good technique to leave master trump(s) undrawn.

The exception is when you have a long suit you wish to run and you can't stand to have the running stopped by a ruff.

This Deal is unusual in that there are two master trumps, but the principle is the same.

Who knows whether you should use a transfer or just bid 4♥ yourself. Assume you decide on the transfer and bid 2♦. Partner bids 2♥ (of course).

Who knows whether you should use a transfer or just bid 4♥ yourself. Assume you decide on the transfer and bid 2♦. Partner bids 2♥ (of course).

Naturally you go ahead and bid 4♥, the final contract.

The contract would be 4♥ played by South.

North plays 4♥. East leads the ♠ Q and West follows with the ♠ 9.

You win the first trick with the ♠ A.

**Board 3**

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 8 2  
♥ Q 9  
♦ J 7 3  
♣ J 9 8 6 3 2

♠ Q J 9 5 3

♥ K 4 3

♦ K 8 2

♣ 10 4

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ A 7 4  
♥ A 8 5 2  
♦ Q 10 9 4  
♣ A K

♠ K 10 6

♥ J 10 7 6

♦ A 6 5

♣ Q 7 5

| West       | North | East | South |
|------------|-------|------|-------|
| 2♠         | Pass  | 1NT  | Pass  |
| All Pass   |       | 3♣   |       |
| 3♣ by East |       |      |       |

The 2♠ bid is used as a transfer to 3♣.

If you don't use this in your system, just consider this hand; you might decide to incorporate it. So you bid 3♣ and everybody passes.

East plays 3♣. South leads the ♥J.

You play dummy's ♥Q hopefully, but North plays the ♥K.

Loser List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 2 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 5

That is one loser too many. The ♣Q MIGHT drop . . . but she won't. There are no finesse positions. So you are going to have to establish a winner somewhere to discard dummy's small ♠.

Do you see it? The ♥8. Take the ♥A. Then play your ♣ A K. As predicted, the ♣Q doesn't fall. Then play a small ♥ to dummy's ♥9. Of course South will take the ♥10, but now your ♥8 is high.

As soon as you get the lead you play the ♥8 and discard dummy's ♠2.

We know, you didn't really play the ♥Q on the first trick in the hope that South had underled the ♥K (although he certainly might have done so).

The real reason for covering was so you could establish the ♥8 by force.

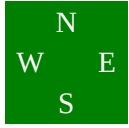
Suppose you had not played the ♥Q to trick one. North would have withheld the ♥K and you'd have had to take your ♥A. Later North would have taken dummy's ♥Q with his ♥K, then played a small ♥ through your ♥8 to South's ♥10 7.

**Board 5**

South Deals  
None Vul

♠ 9 6 4  
♥ K 6 5 2  
♦ 10 7  
♣ Q J 10 3

♠ A K J 7 3  
♥ 8 4 3  
♦ A 5 4  
♣ K 9



♠ 2  
♥ J 10 9  
♦ J 8 6 3  
♣ 8 7 5 4 2

♠ Q 10 8 5  
♥ A Q 7  
♦ K Q 9 2  
♣ A 6

| <i>West</i> | <i>North</i> | <i>East</i> | <i>South</i> |
|-------------|--------------|-------------|--------------|
|             |              |             | 1NT          |
| Pass        | 2♥           | Pass        | 3♠           |
| Pass        | 6♠           |             |              |
| All Pass    |              |             |              |
| 6♠ by South |              |             |              |